

Aliya Merchant

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EDUCATION

Miami University Farmer School of Business

Bachelor of Science in Accountancy | Masters of Science in Accountancy

Entrepreneurship & Business Analytics Minors

- Honors College | Prodesse Scholar | Presidents List (Fall 2024 & Spring 2025)

CPA Certification Eligible: May 2028

Expected Graduation: May 2028

Major GPA: 4.0

PROFESSIONAL & ACCOUNTING EXPERIENCE

Women in Accounting

Dec. 2024 - Present

President | Community Chair

- Budgeted bonding events like matcha making, horse riding, and movie nights to strengthen engagement among 78+ members
- Coordinated corporate visit to professional service firms, creating opportunities for members to engage with professionals
- Arranged monthly recruitment sessions with companies, facilitating member-led Q&A and expanding member networks

The Hillman Group

May 2025 - Aug. 2025

Tax Intern

- Prepared fixed asset roll-forwards, M-3 mapping, and tax estimates/extensions using Excel supporting mid-year tax compliance
- Analyzed Q2 state tax law changes due to the Big Beautiful Bill and supported merger filings across states to save \$34,000
- Executed detailed reconciliations for state-specific property, franchise, and income tax accounts, ensuring accurate balances

No Zero Days

Jun. 2022 - May 2024

Co-Founder

- Built "No Zero Days," an inclusive and healthy protein bite business with no nuts, no added sugar, and varying levels of protein
- Acquired \$1,500 seed funding through Lakota IncubatorEDU and XSquared pitch competitions to fund research and startup costs
- Designed pitch deck and conducted customer research and product testing to enhance customer experience and refine recipes

LEADERSHIP & CAMPUS EXPERIENCE

Alpha Kappa Psi Professional Business Fraternity (Gamma Chi)

May 2025 - Present

Director of Creativity and Innovation | Brother

- Achieved 2nd place in Boston Consulting Group judged case competition by designing a tiered corporate sponsorship model
- Selected from 200+ applicants after three competitive interview rounds, including case studies and behavioral evaluations
- Applied creative analytics to deliver recruitment insights, market events, and promote member learning utilizing AI prompting

Miami University Social Impact Fund

Sep. 2024 - Present

Marketing Director | Analyst

- Evaluated 6+ startup pitches each semester, allocating up to \$25,000 in funding to high-impact, socially-focused seed startups
- Assessed financial statements, analyzed market trends, and evaluated key social impact metrics to guide investment decisions
- Engaged with Cincinnati's startup ecosystem, through Startup Weekend, the Student Venture Capital Summit, and StartupCincy

Dar-E-Zehra Islamic Center

Nov. 2020 - Present

Fundraising Volunteer

- Co-led an Ashura Procession Walk and delivered a speech on social justice to 200+ attendees, fostering community awareness
- Collected \$4,000+ from bake sale fundraisers by directing volunteers, setting prices, organizing displays, and managing logistics
- Instructed Arabic to children ages 9–12, maintained mosque upkeep before and after prayers, and served meals after fasts

Hodge Hall Community Leadership Team

Aug. 2024 - May 2025

Vice President

- Curated and led events such as cookie decorating competitions and wellness initiatives to foster connection among residents
- Spearheaded a community service project donating custom board games with kind messages to a local retirement home
- Facilitated weekly meetings, built agendas, and ensured collaboration to develop effective, solution-oriented plans

Youth in Philanthropy

Jun. 2022 - May 2024

Secretary | Member

- Raised \$20,000+ for local nonprofits in West Chester, enhancing community engagement and supporting vital initiatives
- Directed and managed multiple fundraising events, including a Youth Program, Powderpuff, Culture Potluck, and Movie Night
- Secured sponsors and negotiated free venues for events, significantly reducing costs and maximizing fundraising profit

TECHNICAL SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Excel | SQL | Python | R | Financial & Managerial Accounting | Leadership | Collaboration | Creativity | Problem Solving

Interests: Baking & Recipe Experimentation | Fencing | Reading | Traveling | Event Planning | Philanthropy & Fundraising